Stock Analysis Report

Comparative analysis of Apple (AAPL), NVIDIA (NVDA) and Microsoft (MSFT)

Prepared by Laiba Saeed | Task 1: Financial Analysis | Data as of Oct 30, 2026 close unless noted

Executive Summary

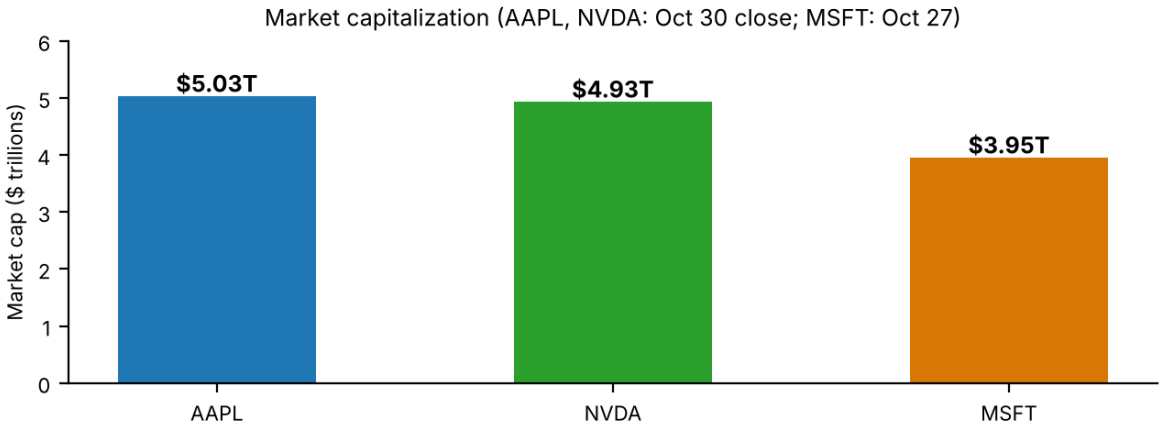
This report compares three US mega-cap technology stocks on market capitalization, P/E ratio, price trend, recent news and key performance indicators. Apple closed Oct 30 as the world's most valuable company at $5.03 trillion, just ahead of NVIDIA at $4.93 trillion, after a sharp chip-stock selloff on AI spending worries. Microsoft sits third at roughly $3.9 trillion. The three stocks tell different stories: Apple is the most expensive on earnings and has risen the most this year, NVIDIA grows fastest and is cheapest on P/E but is the most volatile, and Microsoft is the steady middle option with accelerating cloud growth.

Snapshot of the Three Companies

Metric	Apple (AAPL)	NVIDIA (NVDA)	Microsoft (MSFT)
Share price	$344.63	$204.64	$531.33 (Oct 27)
Market cap	$5.03 T	$4.93 T	~$3.95 T (Oct 27)
P/E ratio (trailing)	~38.4x	~25.9x	~27.7x
Revenue (last 12 months)	$479 B (FY2026)	~$303 B	~$346 B
Latest quarter revenue	$114.5 B (+12%)	$96.2 B (+106%)	$92.3 B (+19%)
Net profit margin	~27-28%	~64% (GAAP)	~40%
Performance in 2026	+27% year to date	+9.7% year to date	~+1.6% over 1 year (Oct 23)
Sector	Consumer tech	Semiconductors	Cloud and software

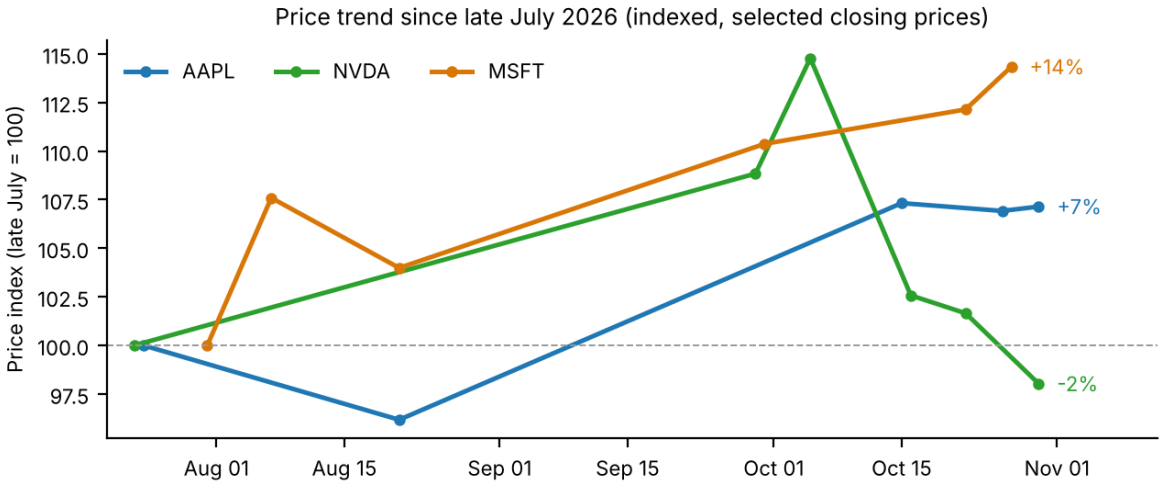
P/E, TTM revenue and margins for NVDA and MSFT are calculated from reported quarterly results and the latest available prices, so they are approximate. NVDA's margin is GAAP and includes large gains on investments.

Market Capitalization



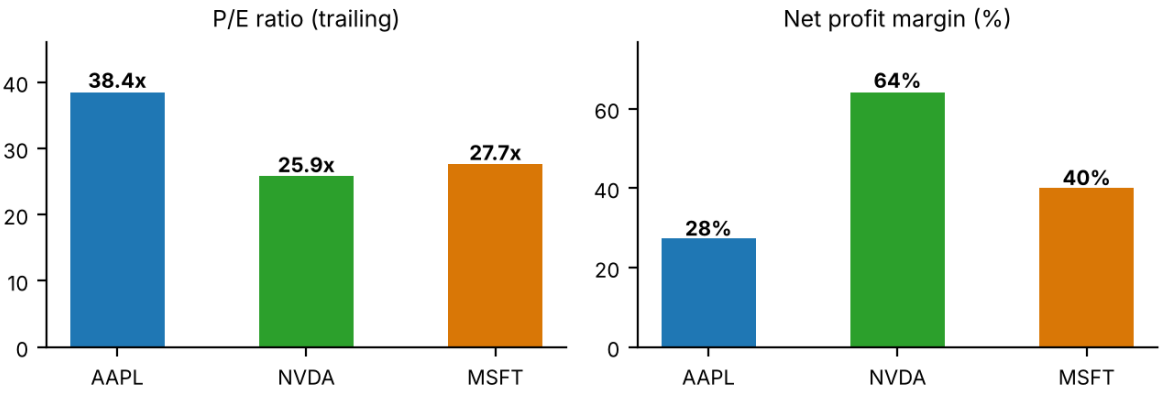
Apple has retaken the top spot from NVIDIA five times. The gap is only about $100 billion, so the ranking can flip again quickly. From Oct 6 to Oct 23, NVIDIA fell about 12% while Apple gained about 4%, as investors moved toward companies with less exposure to AI spending.

Price Trends



Apple rose steadily after a dip in August, setting a record near $348 on Oct 23 when the iPhone Duo reached stores. NVIDIA peaked near $240 in early October, then fell about 15% into Oct 30. Microsoft climbed through the quarter and jumped after its July and October earnings reports. Because the lines start in late July, Microsoft's index already includes its post-earnings jump on Jul 30.

Valuation and Profitability



Apple has the highest P/E (~38x) but the lowest margin, so investors are paying for stability and brand strength more than for fast growth. NVIDIA has the lowest P/E (~26x) despite doubling revenue, because the market doubts how long AI spending can keep growing. Microsoft sits in between with a forward P/E of about 26x and a solid 40% margin.

Recent News and Performance Drivers

Apple. The September quarter brought record revenue of $114.5 billion (up 12%) and EPS of $2.10. Full-year FY2026 revenue was a record $479 billion. The foldable iPhone Duo ($1,999) launched on Oct 23, and John Ternus took over as CEO on Sep 1. Risks: Services growth slowed in the June quarter, and memory costs and supply are a concern. Tariff refunds also boosted recent margins.

NVIDIA. Q2 FY2027 revenue was $96.2 billion (up 106%), with Data Center at $89.0 billion and gross margin of 75%. Guidance for next quarter is about $108 billion. Even so, the stock fell 4.2% on Oct 30 as the semiconductor index dropped about 7% on fears that big tech companies may slow AI spending. The stock is also volatile (beta about 2.2).

Microsoft. Q1 FY2027 (reported Oct 28) revenue was $92.3 billion (up 19%) and Azure grew 48%, above guidance. Management guided Azure growth of 49-50% for the next quarter, and the stock rose after hours. The main concern is the heavy cost of AI infrastructure.

Conclusion

All three companies are financially strong, but they suit different investor views. **Apple** offers the steadiest earnings and the best 2026 return, but at the highest P/E and the lowest margin, so its price already expects a lot. **NVIDIA** has the strongest growth and margins at the lowest P/E, but it moves most with AI sentiment, as the October selloff showed. **Microsoft** balances both: strong cloud growth, a 40% margin and a mid-range valuation, though its stock has gained the least over the past year. Overall, NVIDIA looks cheapest relative to its growth, Apple looks the safest, and Microsoft sits in the middle. The common risk for all three is a slowdown in AI spending. This report is for study purposes and is not investment advice.

Sources

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